

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

MENTAL HEALTH & DRUGS

Cocaine & Heroin

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Mental Health & Drugs
Lesson:	Cocaine & Heroin
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Explain how cocaine and heroin affect the brain's reward system
2. Describe the physical dangers of heroin injection and overdose
3. Recognise overdose signs and describe the correct emergency response
4. Apply refusal strategies and identify support resources

Slide 2: Cocaine — The Fast Addiction

Cocaine is one of the most addictive substances known to science. Understanding how it works is your best protection.

KEY TERM: How Cocaine Works

Cocaine blocks dopamine reuptake — dopamine floods the brain causing intense but short euphoria. Receptors burn out fast. Without cocaine the brain cannot generate normal pleasure, causing deep depression and intense craving.

Form	Route	Onset	Main Risk
Powder cocaine	Snorted	3–5 min	Heart attack, nasal damage
Crack cocaine	Smoked	10 sec	Extreme rapid addiction, psychosis
Injected (IV)	Into vein	Immediate	HIV, overdose, vein collapse

■ ■ ■ Kenya Reality

■ Cocaine and crack use is rising in Nairobi, Mombasa, and Kisumu, partly due to drug trafficking through Kenya's coast. Street cocaine is almost always mixed with other harmful substances. There is no 'pure' street cocaine.

Slide 3: Heroin — The Physical Trap

Heroin creates one of the most brutal physical addictions known to medicine — and one of the most dangerous to life.

KEY TERM: How Heroin Works

Heroin converts to morphine in the brain and binds to opioid receptors — intense pain relief and euphoria. Physical dependence develops in days. Without it: brutal withdrawal. Overdose stops breathing.

Stage	What Happens
First use (rush)	Intense warmth, euphoria, pain relief — 3–5 hours
Regular use (days/weeks)	Tolerance builds — needs more drug for same effect

Stage	What Happens
Withdrawal (hours without drug)	Muscle cramps, vomiting, diarrhoea, sweating, insomnia, extreme anxiety — days of agony
Overdose	Breathing slows and stops — death without naloxone

Slide 4: Overdose — Signs & Emergency Response

Both cocaine and heroin can kill with a single use. Knowing overdose signs can save a life.

Cocaine OD Sign	Heroin OD Sign
Chest pain, irregular heartbeat	Extremely slow or no breathing
Stroke symptoms: confusion, face drooping	Blue/purple lips or fingertips (no oxygen)
Seizures, extreme agitation	Unresponsive — cannot be woken
Very high temperature, sweating	Pinpoint (very small) pupils

■ ■ *Emergency Response*

Slide 5: Recovery & Where to Get Help

Addiction is a brain disease — not a moral failure. Recovery is real and possible with the right support.

Zawadi's older brother became addicted to heroin at 19 while at university in Mombasa. For two years the family was desperate. With NACADA support and inpatient treatment at Coast General, he completed a 6-month rehabilitation programme. He is now 25, working, and speaks in schools about his experience. 'Getting help was the hardest and best thing I ever did.'

Slide 6: Module Video

Watch carefully, then continue to the scenarios.

Slide 7: Real Talk — What Would You Do?

Pick your choice and see the consequence.

Slide 8: Refusal & Protection Strategies

Cocaine and heroin are present in Kenya. Knowing how to say no could save your life.

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. Cocaine primarily works by:

- ☐ A. Slowing the brain down
- ☒ B. Flooding the brain with dopamine, creating intense euphoria and rapid addiction
- ☐ C. Causing sedation and sleep
- ☐ D. Only affecting the lungs

2. 2. Heroin belongs to which drug class?

- ☐ A. Stimulants
- ☒ B. Opioids — derived from opium/morphine
- ☐ C. Hallucinogens
- ☐ D. Cannabis

3. 3. Sharing needles to inject heroin is extremely dangerous because:

- ☐ A. Needles are expensive
- ☒ B. It directly transmits HIV, Hepatitis B and C, and other blood-borne infections
- ☐ C. Only the first person is at risk
- ☐ D. It reduces the drug effect

4. 4. A cocaine or heroin overdose can cause:

- ☐ A. Only a headache
- ☒ B. Respiratory failure, cardiac arrest, seizures, coma, and death
- ☐ C. Better sleep
- ☐ D. Improved performance

5. 5. Withdrawal from heroin is:

- ☐ A. Easy and brief
- ☒ B. Extremely physically painful — muscle cramps, vomiting, sweating, insomnia lasting days
- ☐ C. Comfortable with no symptoms
- ☐ D. Only psychological, not physical

6. 6. 'Crack cocaine' is:

- ☐ A. A type of biscuit
- ☒ B. A smokable, highly addictive form of cocaine with faster and more intense effects
- ☐ C. A weaker form of cocaine
- ☐ D. A legal pain medication

7. 7. Why does cocaine and heroin addiction develop so fast?

- ☐ A. They are natural substances
- ☒ B. They hijack the brain's dopamine reward system — the brain stops producing natural pleasure without the drug
- ☐ C. Users want to get sick
- ☐ D. They are cheap and accessible

8. 8. Which Kenyan institution provides treatment for hard drug addiction?

- ☐ A. Kenya Revenue Authority
- ☒ B. NACADA — National Authority for Campaign Against Drug Abuse
- ☐ C. KNEC
- ☐ D. Kenya Power

9. 9. If you find a friend collapsed after taking drugs, the FIRST action is:

- ☐ A. Wait and see if they wake up
- ☒ B. Call 999/112 immediately and do not leave them alone
- ☐ C. Try to make them vomit
- ☐ D. Post about it on social media

10. 10. The best protection against cocaine and heroin addiction is:

- ☐ A. Trying once to see what it is like
- ☒ B. Never starting — these drugs create addiction after very few uses
- ☐ C. Only using on weekends
- ☐ D. Using in small amounts

Part C: Short Answer (25 marks)

1. 1. Cocaine causes addiction rapidly by flooding the brain with the pleasure chemical _____. (3 marks)

2. 2. Heroin belongs to the drug class called _____, derived from the opium poppy. (3 marks)

3. 3. Sharing needles to inject drugs transmits HIV, Hepatitis B, and Hepatitis _____. (3 marks)

4. 4. The Kenyan authority fighting drug abuse and providing free treatment referrals is _____. (3 marks)

5. 5. A cocaine or heroin overdose can cause breathing to stop — called respiratory _____. (3 marks)

6. Compare how cocaine and heroin each affect the brain's reward system. Why does this make them so addictive? (3 marks marks) (3 marks)

7. Explain THREE physical dangers of heroin injection specifically (4 marks marks) (4 marks)

8. Why is 'I'll just try it once' an extremely dangerous statement about cocaine or heroin? (3 marks marks) (3 marks)